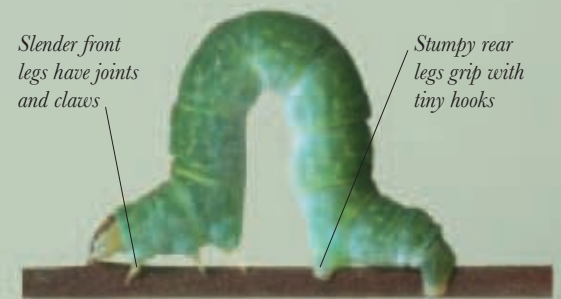


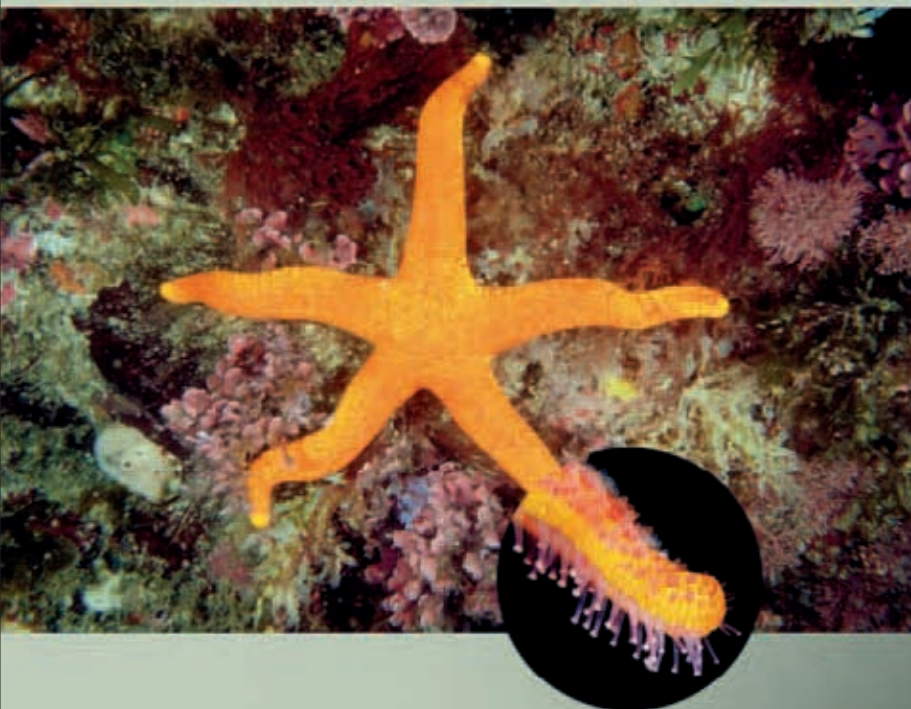
Creeping and sliding

Everything moves in the living world, including plants that turn to follow the sun, and aquatic bacteria that maneuver through the seas. However, animals not only move faster than other life forms, but they also do it in the most amazing variety of ways. They creep, run, swim, and fly, using a huge range of body parts, from muscular suckers to feather-covered wings. Animals that creep and slide often score low marks for speed, but some snakes reach 13 mph (20 kph) over short distances, an impressive achievement for animals without legs.



In the loop

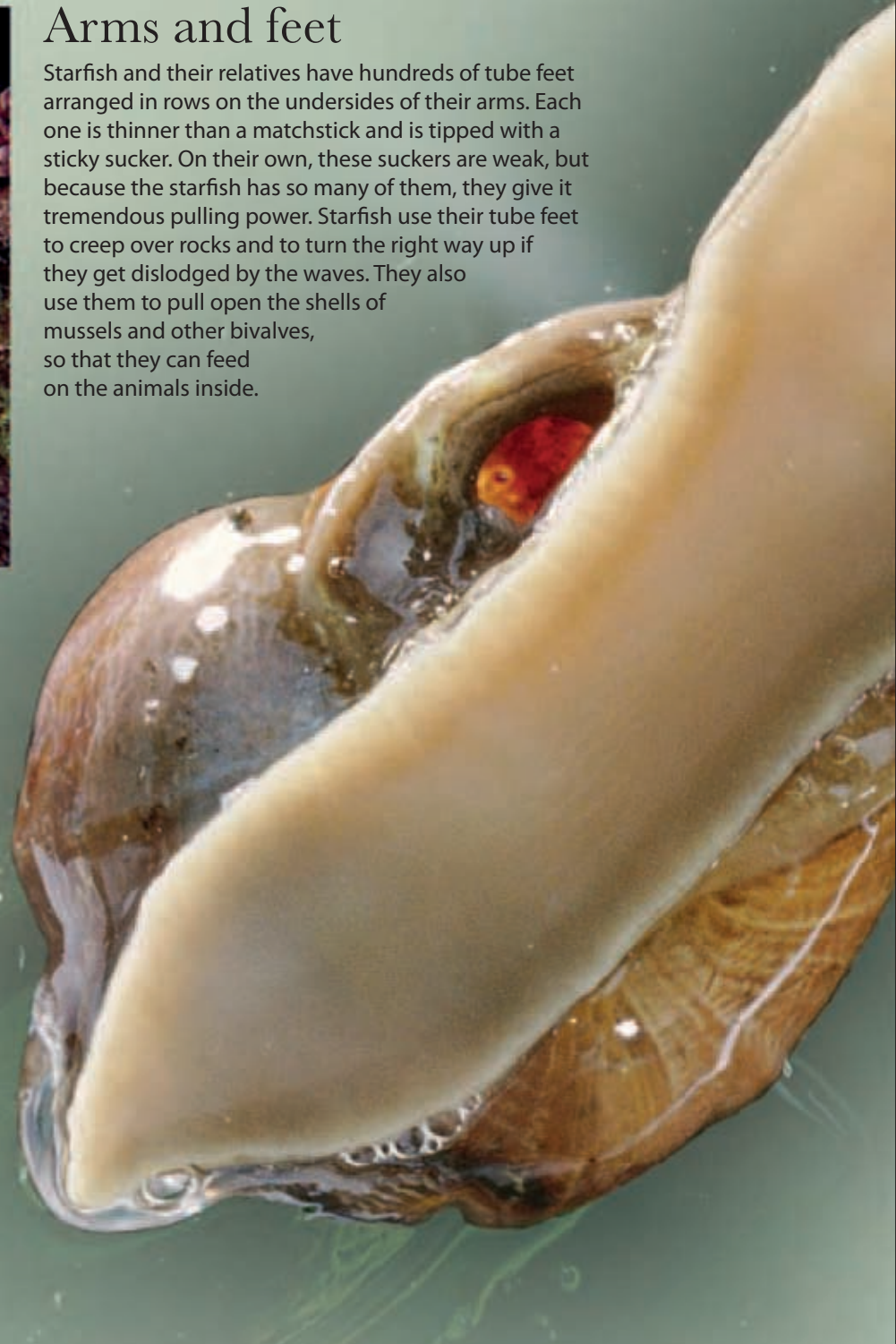
Looper caterpillars get their name from their unusual way of moving. This one has formed a loop and is about to stretch forward by releasing its front legs. Once it has straightened out, it grips with its front legs and releases its back ones, so the loop can re-form. By doing this repeatedly, it moves forward along the twig.



Magnified view of tube feet

Arms and feet

Starfish and their relatives have hundreds of tube feet arranged in rows on the undersides of their arms. Each one is thinner than a matchstick and is tipped with a sticky sucker. On their own, these suckers are weak, but because the starfish has so many of them, they give it tremendous pulling power. Starfish use their tube feet to creep over rocks and to turn the right way up if they get dislodged by the waves. They also use them to pull open the shells of mussels and other bivalves, so that they can feed on the animals inside.



Suckers and slime

Creeping across a pane of glass, this garden snail shows off its suckerlike foot. Many animals have suckers, but most use them just for holding on. A snail's foot not only sucks it to surfaces, but it also powers its motion. The movement is produced by the muscle fibers in the foot stretching and contracting in waves. Each wave starts at the tail end of the foot and moves forward to the head, pushing the snail along. To smooth its path, the snail produces lots of sticky mucus, which leaves a glistening trail. At top speed, a garden snail can move at 26 ft (8 m) per hour.

Slime reduces friction between foot and glass